A-A-58010

16 November 1992

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

RAILWAY CAR SPOTTER, SELF-PROPELLED 30,000 POUND DRAW BAR PULL

General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description (CID)

1. Abstract:
This Commercial Item Description describes a commercial railway car spotter. The spotter shall be a diesel engine driven vehicle with railway car couplers designed for operation on rails or on paved surfaces. The spotter shall be capable of a 30,000 pound draw bar pull while utilizing only one coupler. The quantities and types shall be specified by the purchaser.

2. Salient Characteristics:

2.1 The railway car spotter shall be free from faulty construction or any defect which affects appearance, serviceability, or durability. All components and accessories shall be represented in the manufacturer's sales data as standard or optional. The railway car spotter shall be representative of the quality and workmanship found in the rail car spotters offered for new commercial sale. Additional or better features which are not specifically prohibited by this commercial item description but which are a part of the manufacturer's standard product, shall be included in the rail car spotter being furnished.

2.2 The railway car spotter shall be either a locomotive rail car type, or a truck-tractor type vehicle.

2.2.1 The locomotive rail car type shall be capable of lowering and raising the road wheels for rail to road transfer. The rail wheels shall not be less than 18 inches in diameter.

2.2.2 The truck-tractor type shall be capable of lowering and raising flanged guide wheels for rail to road transfer. The truck-tractor type shall be capable

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AMSC N/A

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of locking out the steering mechanism during rail operation. The truck-tractor type shall be capable of four-wheel drive during rail operation.

2.3 The spotter shall have a minimum of four flanged rail wheels for operation on 56-1/2-inch gauge trackage and four pneumatic-tired wheels for operation on unimproved and paved road surfaces.

2.4 The spotter shall be capable of crossing over semi-exposed rails, and transferring from road to rail and road to rail operation with no sign of instability and no loss of control.

2.5 The spotter shall be capable of pulling or pushing railway cars, with a minimum starting tractive effort of 30,000 lb while utilizing a single coupler without the drive wheel spinning. Tractive effort shall be measured through the use of either steel wheels or rubber tires on a high rail surface.

2.6 The spotter shall be capable of the following performance on dry level track with no sign of instability, and no loss of control with any combination of loading and motion, and no sign of damage or permanent distortion after operation at maximum capacity:

a. The spotter shall be capable of moving 8 or more railway cars having a minimum distributed gross weight of 1500 tons or more.

b. The spotter shall be capable of maintaining a constant speed of not less than 10 mph for not less than 1/2 mile while moving three or more railway cars having a minimum gross distributed weight of 450 tons.

c. The spotter shall be capable of attaining a speed no less than 20 mph in either direction of travel on rails without a connected load and 10 mph forward on level paving.

d. The spotter shall be capable of moving three or more railway cars having a minimum gross weight of 400 tons up a one-half mile long minimum 2.0% grade without the drive wheel spinning.

2.7 The spotter shall have an enclosed operating cab. The front and rear windshield shall be provided with automatic wipers. Seating shall be provided for the operator and at least one crew member. Mirrors shall be provided on each side of the spotter to provide an unobstructed view along each side of the coupled freight car(s) and for the safe performance of all intended functions. A cab heater and window defroster shall be provided. The following instrumentation shall be provided within the cab:

a. An engine hour meter
b. A fuel level gauge
c. A lubricating oil pressure gauge
d. A cooling liquid temperature indicator
e. An ammeter
f. A voltage meter

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g. Brake reservoir pressure gauge
h. Brake line pressure gauge
i. A speed indicator functional in both over-the-road and on-rail modes.

Instrumentation shall be illuminated during night operation. An air or vacuum horn shall be provided. A 12 volt (V) direct current radio outlet shall be provided. A 5 lb dry powder type fire extinguisher shall be mounted within the cab. When specified, the rail car spotter shall have an air conditioning system. A tool box shall be provided to carry tools and accessories as required to operate the spotter. The tool box shall be attached securely to the spotter in an accessible and protected location.

2.8 Handholds, platforms, and railings shall be provided for the safety of operating personnel and shall conform to the requirements of CFR part 229 and 231, and AAR regulations.

2.9 Two couplers, one on either end of the spotter, shall be provided. The couplers shall be either a standard fully operating AAR coupler, or a coupling device designed to mate with railway car couplers conforming to the requirements of the AAR. The coupler shall be powered positioned and self centering on contact. Air brake connection hose assemblies shall be installed with the couplers.

2.10 The spotter shall be equipped with foot actuated hydraulic service brakes and parking brakes for both rail and road use. On rails, the stopping distance from 5 mph to a dead standstill, without railway car loading shall not exceed 50 feet. The road service brakes shall conform to DOT Federal Motor Carrier Safety regulations, sections 393.40, and 393.45 through 393.47. An AAR railway car air braking system shall be provided so that one or more moving cars can be brought to a stop without assistance from the spotter braking system. The air compressor shall be a powered takeoff from the spotter engine. The parking brake shall hold on either road or rails against a horizontal pull of not less than 4,000 lb.

2.11 A sanding system shall be provided. The sanding system shall be complete with weatherproof steel sandboxes, piping, and electric or air-operated valves for sanding the rails in front and back of each wheel in either direction of travel on rails. The sandboxes shall have a capacity for not less than 8 hours of operation or 90 lb, whichever is greater. The sanders shall be furnished with a silica-gel bag or other dampness control.

2.12 The spotter shall be provided with a minimum of two sealed beam automotive type headlights, and backup lights. A turn signal operating unit shall be provided and shall be self-canceling, with visible and audible flash indicators. An independently controlled spotlight, aimed at the coupling device shall be provided. Step lights shall be provided on the bottom of the access steps. An interior light shall be mounted on the ceiling with a switch mounted on the sidewall. A strobe light shall be mounted on the cab roof.

2.13 For road drive, an audible alarm shall be provided to caution personnel in the area when the vehicle is in the reverse gear. The alarm shall be in

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accordance with SAE J994, Type D.

2.14 An automatic transmission shall be provided with at least three selective driving ranges in each direction for rail travel, and not less than three forward speeds and reverse for road travel.

2.15 A winterization system, if required, shall be provided. The winterization system shall, at a minimum, consist of an ether start and a 1500 watt, 110 volt (V) engine block heater.

2.16 A snow plow, if required, for rail operation shall be provided as an accessory item.

2.17 The rail car spotter shall be painted with the manufacturer's commercial paint. The color shall be safety yellow or equivalent. The front of the spotter shall be identified with the letter "F" as required by CFR part 229.11.

2.18 The manufacturer shall provide a non-corrosive license plate mounting bracket with the vehicle. The bracket shall be easily accessible and visible from the rear of the spotter.

3. Regulatory Requirements:

3.1 The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent possible.

3.1.1 For the purpose of this requirement, recovered materials are those materials which have been collected from solid waste and reprocessed to become a source of raw materials, as distinguished from virgin raw materials. The components, pieces and parts incorporated in the spotter may be newly fabricated from recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, provided the spotter produced meets all other requirements of this CID. Used, rebuilt or remanufactured components, pieces and parts shall not be incorporated.

4. Contractor Certification:
The contractor shall certify and maintain substantial evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this commercial item description, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to the delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

5. Market Acceptability:

5.1 Commercial. The vehicle furnished must be the latest model as of the date of award (with minor modifications, as that term is defined in DoD FAR Supplement 252.211-7012, Paragraph K-85 of the solicitation) of an established product previously produced and sold in substantial commercial quantities (exceeding the criteria at FAR 15.804-3(f)(2)(ii)(A)) for at least 2 years immediately preceding the issuance date of the solicitation. The vehicle furnished, or earlier models of it, absent minor modifications, shall have

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routinely been supported with spares/repair parts which were produced or sold in the normal course of business. At the time delivery, the contractor shall furnish the Administrative Contracting Officer with verification of compliance with these requirements. Offerors shall provide, as part of their proposals, the following information on the vehicle (or its earlier models) being offered as a commercial item:

(1) Total sales to the U.S. Government or to contractors for U.S. Government use during the 2 years immediately preceding the issuance date of the solicitation.

(2) Total sale of the item to the general public during the 2 years immediately preceding the issuance date of the solicitation.

(3) Length of time the item has been sold in the commercial market place.

(4) Points of contact and phone numbers of customers to which the item has been sold in the commercial market place.

(5) Other pertinent information necessary to determine that the item is an established commercial item.

6. Packaging, Packing and Marking:
Unless otherwise provided in the contract, the truck shall be prepared for delivery by common carrier and shall provide for protection against loss or damage while in transit. An identification plate, permanently marked, shall be securely mounted at the driver's compartment. The identification plate shall contain the following information:

NOMENCLATURE
MANUFACTURER'S MODEL NUMBER
MANUFACTURER'S SERIAL NUMBER
MANUFACTURER'S NAME
MANUFACTURER'S ADDRESS
MANUFACTURER'S SERVICE PHONE NUMBER
DATE OF MANUFACTURE
CONTRACT NUMBER
NATIONAL STOCK NUMBER
REGISTRATION NUMBER

7. Contractor Requirements:

7.1 Two sets of commercial manuals, including operation, maintenance and parts shall be provided with each spotter delivered. The parts manuals shall list the contractor's part numbers, as well as, the component and equipment manufacturer's part numbers, as applicable. The contractor shall supply a video tape training course. The video course shall verbally and visually provide the users with all the information required for the maintenance and the operation of the spotter and its components using the provided commercial manual as a baseline. After reviewing the video tapes, the students shall be able to operate safely all of the system components and shall be able to install,

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1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
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I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD)
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3. DOCUMENT TITLE

RAILWAY CAR SPOTTER, SELF-PROPELLED 30,000 POUND DRAWBAR PULL

4. NATURE OF CHANGE *(Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.)*

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)
	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME	b. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON
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